many were economic, political or military. But some were foreign, specifically Jewish or Israeli. The Chabad House was one of them, and this was the first time it was discussed. Headley was very pleased and told Abdur Rehman Syed, who expressed his satisfaction and told his friend to insist upon its inclusion. Iqbal was also 'very happy to know that Chabad House had been chosen as a target,' according to Headley who traveled back to Mumbai for the month of July. He surveyed numerous targets, including all of those struck several months later.[103] Notably, Headley assessed other possible Jewish targets during this time as well, but at least one was deemed less appealing because only Indian Jews frequented it.[104] Conversely, American and Israeli Jews patronized the Chabad House. The primary aim was to enhance Lashkar's jihadi credibility, but its choice also may have presented the group with what was perceived to be an opportunity to damage India's strong civil and military relationship with Israel.[105]

Upon returning to Pakistan in August 2008, Headley first met with Iqbal and briefed him on the various targets. He then traveled to Muzaffarabad, where Sajid informed him the attackers were being trained. Lashkar had settled on a ten-man fidayeen squad and was preparing two sets of targets depending on when the gunmen landed. Although the attacks were slated to take place within a month's time, questions still remained. Major Iqbal expressed concern about the battle-readiness of the attackers given that most only began the Daura-e-Khasa two months prior and none had any combat experience.[106] Debates were also ongoing with regard to the choice of targets. Zaki-ur Rehman Lakhvi called a meeting of Lashkar's hierarchy to discuss the operation, and though Headley did not attend he learned that at least one of the group's leaders expressed reservations about striking the Chabad House. The man in question argued that doing so would create another enemy for Lashkar and could cause additional problems for the group in the future.[107] It is difficult to determine how vehement the opposition to striking the Chabad House was. Once it was promoted as a possible target, however, arguing against it almost certainly would have been an uphill battle. With its attack on the Chabad House, Lashkar became the first Pakistani jihadi group to actualize the fulminating 'Hindu-Zionist-Crusader' rhetoric common to many of them.